

Opening & Concluding sentences are highlighted in yellow

Reporting expressions are highlighted in red

Linking expressions are highlighted in blue

Critical expressions are highlighted in green

Sample Critical Summary

1 In this TED Talk, **Jennifer D. Sciubba argues** that the most significant demographic
2 trend of the twenty-first century is not population growth but declining fertility, population
3 ageing and, eventually, population decline. **Although** the world's population is expected to
4 increase from around eight billion to between nine and ten billion people, **she claims** that
5 this overall growth obscures deeper changes. Fertility rates have been falling globally for
6 decades, and many countries are expected to experience substantial population losses over
7 the coming century.

8 **Sciubba suggests** that these demographic shifts will have major social, economic and
9 political consequences because people form the foundation of societies as workers,
10 taxpayers, voters and caregivers. **As** populations age, fewer workers will be available to
11 support growing numbers of retirees, placing pressure on pension systems and public
12 finances. **She argues** that simply offering financial incentives to encourage higher birth
13 rates is unlikely to solve the problem, citing countries such as South Korea, **where**
14 expensive pronatalist policies have had limited success.

15 **To illustrate possible responses** to demographic change, **Sciubba describes** three
16 future scenarios. In a "status quo" world, governments fail to adapt existing institutions,
17 leading to labour shortages, economic strain and weakening welfare systems. In a "fearful"
18 world, governments and societies respond negatively through restrictions on reproductive
19 choice and immigration, creating social division and reducing international cooperation.
20 **While** these risks are real, **the speaker contends** that such outcomes are neither
21 inevitable nor desirable.

22 Instead, **Sciubba advocates** a "resilient" world in which countries adjust proactively to
23 demographic realities. **She argues** that greater openness to immigration, investment in
24 education and health, longer working lives and the strategic use of technology could help
25 societies adapt successfully. **She also emphasises** the need to view older people as
26 valuable contributors rather than as burdens. **Ultimately, Sciubba concludes** that
27 population ageing is unavoidable, but societies retain the ability to shape its consequences
28 through thoughtful policy choices.

29 **While the speaker presents a persuasive case** for adaptation rather than resistance,
30 **her emphasis on immigration and extending working lives may underestimate** the

31 political and practical difficulties involved in implementing such measures in different
32 national contexts.